

User Manual

Every screen, every button, and what happens when you press it.
Written for the people doing the hiring, not the people who set the tool up.

Four screens Two ways to work Nothing sends without a human

START The idea in one minute

Your candidates live in a Google Sheet. This dashboard reads that sheet, helps you write to people, and writes the result back. There is nothing else to learn: if a name is in the sheet, it is in the app, and every change the app makes appears in the sheet.

There are **two ways to work**, and knowing which one you are in explains most of the interface:

WAY	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHERE
The pipeline	Forty applicants for one role, all getting the same kind of email. Tick them, generate drafts, read, approve, send in one go.	Top toolbar of the Inbox
The composer	One person, one message. Say what it should cover in plain English; the model writes it using their details from the sheet.	Right-hand panel of the Inbox

Both end in the same place — a real email from a real mailbox — and both stop for a human before they get there.

THE FOUR SCREENS

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Inbox	Everyone in the pipeline, and the composer. Where you spend your day.
Templates	The reusable emails, and their tone. Generate, preview, activate, attach a file.
Console	Diagnostics: the credential check, and the log of every send ever attempted.
Settings	The master switches — dry run, drafting, sending — and the branding values.

A light/dark toggle sits at the end of the navigation bar. It only changes how the app looks to you.

SCREEN 1 Inbox

Everyone from the Applicants tab, newest activity first.

The banner at the top

Read this before anything else. It has three states and it tells you whether your clicks will reach real people.

BANNER	MEANING
Dry run is on	Nothing leaves the building. Sends are recorded in the log and marked <i>dry run</i> . Safe to experiment.
Live sending is enabled	Emails reach real candidates. The Send buttons turn red as a second reminder.
Sending is broken	Dry run is off but no mailbox is configured. Every send is <i>refused</i> — nothing is quietly recorded as sent. Tell whoever set the app up.

The six counters

Total · Awaiting draft · Awaiting approval · Ready to send · Sent · Needs attention.

Needs attention is the one to watch: it combines rows that failed with duplicate rows. Anything above zero deserves a look before a bulk send.

The pipeline toolbar

These four act on everyone you have **ticked** in the list. They are deliberately greyed out unless every ticked row is at the right stage — you cannot approve something that was never drafted.

BUTTON	DOES	WORKS ON ROWS AT
Generate drafts	Picks the best matching template for each person and writes their email into the sheet.	NEW, DRAFTED, FAILED
Approve	Marks a draft as fit to send. A human reading it is the whole point.	DRAFTED
Unapprove	Takes it back for another edit.	APPROVED
Send	Sends every approved draft. Always asks first, listing the addresses.	APPROVED

The Send button reads **Dry-run send** while dry run is on, and turns red reading **Send** when it is off. The confirmation lists the first twelve recipients so you can see who is about to be emailed.

Refresh from sheet

The sheet can be edited by anyone at any time — by hand, by a paste, by a colleague — so the page can go stale while you look at it.  re-reads it without losing your place, your selection, or your scroll position. The label beside it says how long ago the data was read.

Refresh after anyone pastes new rows in, and before any bulk send.

The duplicates warning

If two rows share an `applicant_id` or an email address, a warning appears naming the exact sheet rows, and every affected row gets a `duplicate` tag in the list.

A repeated id is the dangerous one. Actions find a person by id and take the *first* row that matches, so acting on the second one silently changes the first. You would see a success message naming the right person while the wrong row moved. A repeated email is milder — that person simply gets the email twice. Fix both in the sheet, then press Refresh.

Finding people

- **Search** covers name, email, id, role and notes.
- **Three filters** — role, stage, category — combine with each other and with the search.
- **Group by** stacks the list under headings by category, stage or role. Useful for seeing an entire role's pipeline at once.
- **Bulk category:** tick several people and a box appears to set the category on all of them.

Adding someone

 adds a row to the Applicants tab without opening the spreadsheet. Only the email is required; role and category offer suggestions from what already exists.

Fill in **Notes** if you can. It is passed to the model verbatim and it is the difference between a generic email and one that mentions where you met them.

The candidate panel

Select someone and the right-hand side fills in: their name, address, stage, category, role and id, then their notes in italics, then the last email that was sent to them.

Two fields are editable right there, each with its own  :

- **Email** — for fixing a typo or filling in a blank. A send to a malformed address is refused, so this saves a trip to the spreadsheet. The app will not let you save an address that already belongs to someone else.
- **Category** — affects which template matches them.

Each Save button stays greyed out until you actually change the value.

SCREEN 1B

Writing to one person

The composer, in the order you use it.

1 • Say what the email should cover

Plain English, in the big box. You are briefing a colleague, not writing the email:

invite her to a 30-minute intro call next week, mention it is remote, ask for two possible time slots

You never type their name, role or your company details. Those come from their sheet row and the branding settings. Being specific about the *content* is what improves the result — being specific about the person is already done for you.

2 • Base it on a template (optional)

Only active templates appear here. Choosing one gives the model a structure and tone to follow. Leaving it on *No template* lets the model write from your brief alone.

3 • Fill the boxes

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES	NEEDS
 Write with AI	Writes a fresh email from your brief, their details and the template's tone.	A brief, or a template
Use template as-is	Fills the template in with their details. No model involved, instant, free.	A template

Both only ever *fill the boxes below*. Nothing is sent, and nothing is saved to the sheet, until you press Send yourself. Run  Write with AI as many times as you like; each press replaces what is there.

4 • Read it and edit it

Subject and Message are ordinary text boxes — edit freely. The message is HTML, so `<p>` makes a paragraph and `<br>` a line break, but you can also just type sentences. **Preview** underneath shows it as the recipient will see it.

Always read it before sending. The model is fast and usually good, and neither of those is the same as correct. It is writing to a real person about their job.

5 • Attach files (optional)

 **Attach files** takes files from your computer for this one email. Several at a time, up to 15MB total; each appears as a removable chip. For a file that should go out with *every* use of a template, set it on the template instead — see the next screen.

6 • Send

The button reads **Send**, or a red **Send for real** when dry run is off. It stays greyed out until the subject and message are both filled and no `{{field}}` remains.

If you see *"Still has an unfilled `{{field}}`"*, some placeholder never got a value — often because that person's row is missing a detail. Type over it, or fill the cell in the sheet and refresh. The app blocks the send rather than mail somebody a literal `{{name}}`.

SCREEN 2 Templates

Reusable emails. This is where the house tone lives.

Generating one

Describe the email — purpose, tone, optionally a role and extra instructions — and press **Generate**.

Generated templates arrive switched off. They are saved *inactive* and cannot be used until you preview one and press **Activate**. Nothing a model wrote can reach a candidate before a person has read it.

Reading the table

COLUMN	MEANING
Scope	Which role and category it is for. default marks the fallback used when nothing else fits.
AI	personalised means it contains <code>{{ai_body}}</code> , so each use writes a fresh paragraph for that person and spends model quota. static means the same words every time, and costs nothing.
File	An attachment that goes out with every send. Click it to check the link.
Status	active templates can be used; inactive ones are invisible everywhere else in the app.

Preview, activate, attach

Preview opens the template rendered as an email, with its raw HTML underneath if you want it. From there you can also set an attachment.

Attachments are a **public link**, not an upload — a Google Drive file shared "anyone with the link", or any other public URL. It is fetched fresh at send time, so replacing the file at that link updates every future email with no template edit. Nothing over 15MB will send.

How a template gets chosen

When you press **Generate drafts** in bulk, the app scores every active template against each person:

SITUATION	EFFECT
Template's role matches theirs	Strongly preferred
Template is for a <i>different</i> role	Disqualified — never used by mistake
Category also matches	Preferred over role alone
Nothing fits	Falls back to the default, and records that it did

So: one `default` template as a safety net, plus a specific one per role. Leave a template's role blank to let it apply to anybody.

MERGE FIELDS

Anything in double braces is replaced per person.

FROM THEIR ROW	FROM SETTINGS	SPECIAL
<code>{{name}}</code>	<code>{{company_name}}</code>	<code>{{ai_body}}</code>
<code>{{first_name}}</code>	<code>{{hr_name}}</code>	a paragraph written per person
<code>{{email}}</code>	<code>{{hr_signature}}</code>	
<code>{{job_role}}</code>	<code>{{company_email}}</code>	
<code>{{category}}</code>	<code>{{company_phone}}</code>	
<code>{{applicant_id}}</code>	<code>{{company_logo_url}}</code>	

A field with no value is left visible rather than silently removed, which is what makes the "unfilled field" block possible.

SCREEN 3

Settings

Three switches that matter, and the values every email is built from.

Dry run

The banner at the top, with a button reading `Go live` or `Back to dry run`. Turning it off asks for confirmation, because it is the single switch between practising and emailing real people.

Leave it **on** while learning, while testing a new template, and any time you are unsure. Sends are still logged, so a dry run tells you exactly what would have happened.

The two master switches

SWITCH	CONTROLS
Drafting	The <code>Generate drafts</code> action. Off means no model quota can be spent in bulk.
Sending	Every send, bulk and one-off. Off by default — turn it on deliberately.

These take effect on the next click, with no restart. They are also enforced behind the scenes, so switching one off genuinely stops the action rather than only hiding the button.

Other settings

Shown read-only, edited in the Config tab of the spreadsheet. These are the values every email is built from — company name, the signature, the phone numbers, the reply-to address, the daily cap.

Change one and every future email changes with it. Nothing already sent is affected.

SCREEN 4 Console

Where you go when something looks wrong.

Preflight

Run preflight checks every credential without sending anything or writing a row: the sheet is reachable, its columns are right, the model answers, the mailbox logs in, and there are no duplicate ids or malformed addresses.

Run it after any change to the spreadsheet's structure, and before a big send. If a check fails it names the fix.

The email log

Every send attempt ever made, newest first, with three counters above it: delivered today, failed today, logged all time.

RESULT	MEANING
sent	Genuinely delivered to the mail server.
dry run	Simulated. Nothing was delivered.
failed	Rejected. Hover the tag for the reason.

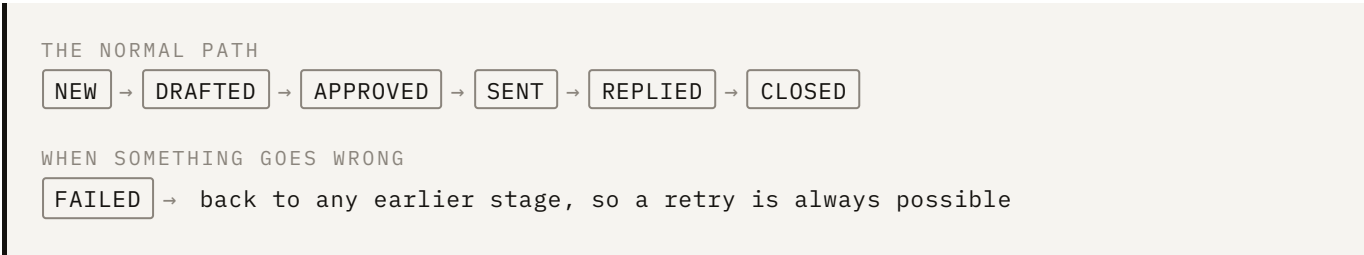
The log is written *before* the candidate's row is updated, so a send can never be missing from it. It is the honest record — if the two ever disagree, believe the log.

Every real send also lands in the sending account's Gmail Sent folder, which is a second, independent copy.

REFERENCE

Stages

The tag on every candidate. It is the app's memory of where you left off.



STAGE	MEANS	SET BY
NEW	In the sheet, nothing written yet.	You, adding them
DRAFTED	An email exists and is waiting to be read.	Generate drafts
APPROVED	A human read it and it is fit to send.	Approve
SENT	It left the building.	Send
REPLIED	They answered. Set by hand — replies arrive in a real mailbox, not here.	You, in the sheet
CLOSED	Finished with. The end of the line.	You, in the sheet
FAILED	Something went wrong; the reason is in the row.	The app

A failed send never claims to have worked. The row stays APPROVED with the error recorded, so you can fix the cause and press Send again without wondering whether it went out twice.

Why is this button greyed out?

Generate drafts	At least one ticked, and every ticked row at NEW, DRAFTED or FAILED. Also the Drafting switch on.
Approve	Every ticked row at DRAFTED.
Unapprove	Every ticked row at APPROVED.
Send (bulk)	Every ticked row at APPROVED, the Sending switch on, and a working mailbox.
✨ Write with AI	Something in the brief box, or a template chosen.
Use template as-is	A template chosen.
Send (composer)	Subject and message filled, no {{field}} left, Sending switch on.
Save (email, category)	A value that differs from what is already stored.
Add candidate	An email address.

Hovering a disabled button usually explains itself. If a whole row of buttons is dead, check the banner at the top of the Inbox first.

Three recipes

Forty applicants for one role

1. Paste them into the Applicants tab, then press **Refresh from sheet**.
2. Clear the duplicates warning if one appears.
3. Filter to that role. Tick the ones you want.
4. **Generate drafts**.
5. **Open several and read them.** Not all forty — enough to trust the template.
6. Tick, **Approve**, then **Send**. Check the addresses in the confirmation.
7. Check the Console log afterwards.

One message to one person

1. Search their name, select them.
2. Check the email address is right; fix it there if not.
3. Type the brief. Pick a template if you want its tone.
4. **Write with AI**, read, edit.
5. Attach anything needed, then **Send**.

Someone new, not from the sheet

1. **+ New**, fill in at least the email, and write a real note about them.
2. They are selected automatically — write to them straight away.

REFERENCE

What the app will not let you do

Worth knowing, because it tells you how much you can safely experiment.

- **Nothing sends by itself.** There is no schedule and no background job. Every email is a button a person pressed.
- **The AI never sends.** It only fills boxes you then read.
- **Generated templates start inactive.** A person has to activate them.
- **Sending is off twice over** by default — the dry run switch and the sending switch, both flipped deliberately.
- **An unfilled `{{field}}` blocks the send** rather than mailing someone a placeholder.
- **A broken mailbox refuses sends** rather than logging them as delivered.
- **A failed send leaves the row unsent**, so retrying is always safe.
- **Bulk sends confirm first**, listing who is about to be emailed.

IF SOMETHING LOOKS WRONG

SYMPTOM	TRY
Someone is missing	Press Refresh. Then check they have an <code>applicant_id</code> — rows without one are ignored.
A change did not stick	Someone edited the sheet at the same time. Refresh and redo it.
"Write with AI" does nothing	The model key is missing or out of quota. Console → Preflight will say.
Emails are not arriving	Check dry run is off, Sending is on, and the log in Console. A <code>failed</code> tag names the reason.
Broken logo in a received email	Expected when testing from a local machine; correct on the live site.
First load is slow	The free hosting sleeps when idle. Around thirty seconds, once.